

D590

Public Health Administration

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

Two county health agencies have just merged into one department of 300 staff, whose headquarters is in a historic courthouse. Morale is low and staff must adopt new ways of working. Which leadership approach fits best?

- A. Transactional: rely only on rewards for compliance and penalties for mistakes.
- B. Autocratic, because strict control always works best in a merger.
- C. Laissez-faire: step back and let teams sort it out.
- D. Transformational: build a shared vision, involve staff, and develop their skills.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A health department compares two quit-smoking programs. Program A costs \$200,000 and produces 100 quitters. Program B, designed by a well-known university, costs \$150,000 and produces 60 quitters. Which program is more cost-effective?

- A. Program A, because it helps more people no matter the cost.
- B. Program A: \$2,000 per quitter vs. \$2,500 for Program B.
- C. Program B, because it costs less in total.
- D. Program B, because a well-known university designed it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Program A costs \$200,000 and produces 100 quitters; Program B costs \$150,000 and produces 60. What is the incremental cost per additional quitter of choosing A over B?

- A. \$1,250
- B. \$2,000
- C. About \$833
- D. \$50,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A nutrition assistance clinic with long waits, and a newly painted lobby mural, tries a new check-in process on Tuesdays for two weeks. Staff then compare the measured wait times with what they predicted. Which PDSA phase is this comparison?

- A. Study.
- B. Act.
- C. Plan.
- D. Do.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A county immunization clinic under a newly hired director tracks the percentage of children who receive each vaccine on the recommended schedule. In Donabedian's model, what kind of measure is this?

- A. Structure.
- B. A measure of the director's performance only.
- C. Process.
- D. Outcome.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic reports the number of certified vaccinators on staff and whether its vaccine refrigerators meet temperature standards. What kind of measures are these?

- A. Outcome.
- B. Impact.
- C. Process.
- D. Structure.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A person with active tuberculosis, who runs a popular neighborhood bakery, keeps missing doses of treatment. What should the health department try first?

- A. Close the bakery.
- B. Take no action to respect the person's autonomy.
- C. Seek a court order for detention right away.
- D. Directly observed therapy with supports such as transportation help or incentives.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

Each month, an administrator at a public health clinic that recently upgraded its phone system compares actual patient visits with targets and adjusts staffing when visits fall short. Which management function is this?

- A. Organizing.
- B. Leading.
- C. Controlling.
- D. Planning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

At a press event, a state announces federal funds that may be used only for childhood lead-poisoning prevention activities listed by the funder. What type of grant is this?

- A. A block grant.
- B. A categorical grant.
- C. Any grant can be spent on any health purpose.
- D. Unrestricted general revenue.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A state wants federal funding that it can spread across several prevention priorities it selects itself. Which type of grant fits?

- A. Clinic fee revenue.
- B. A categorical grant.
- C. A block grant.
- D. A single-disease earmark.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

In a SWOT analysis, a local health department, whose director recently spoke at a national conference, lists this item: A new state law will cut funding for local health departments next year. Where does it belong?

- A.** Threat.
- B.** Opportunity.
- C.** Weakness.
- D.** Strength.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In the same SWOT analysis, the department notes that many of its nurses are bilingual. Where does this belong?

- A.** Threat.
- B.** Strength.
- C.** Weakness.
- D.** Opportunity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

Two county health agencies have just merged into one department of 300 staff, ~~whose headquarters is in a historic courthouse~~. Morale is low and staff must adopt new ways of working. Which leadership approach fits best?

Target word: best leadership approach **Decides:** Large-scale change with low morale.

A	Adjacent category	Useful for routine tasks but weak for building commitment through change.
B	Absolute language	No single style always works; control alone deepens low morale.
C	Inverted operation	Removes direction when it is most needed.
D	Correct	Inspires commitment during major change.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A health department compares two quit-smoking programs. Program A costs \$200,000 and produces 100 quitters. Program B, ~~designed by a well-known university~~, costs \$150,000 and produces 60 quitters. Which program is more cost-effective?

Target word: cost per outcome **Decides:** \$200,000/100 vs. \$150,000/60.

A	Adjacent category	Right choice, wrong reason: that is effectiveness, not cost-effectiveness.
B	Correct	Lower cost per quitter is more cost-effective.
C	Dropped element	Ignores how many people quit.
D	Camouflage	Reputation does not change the numbers.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

Program A costs \$200,000 and produces 100 quitters; Program B costs \$150,000 and produces 60. What is the incremental cost per additional quitter of choosing A over B?

Target word: incremental cost-effectiveness ratio **Decides:** $(\$200,000 - \$150,000) / (100 - 60)$.

A	Correct	$\$50,000 / 40 = \$1,250$.
B	Confusion set	Program A's average cost per quitter, not the incremental cost.
C	Wrong stem number	Divides \$50,000 by B's 60 quitters instead of the 40 extra.
D	Dropped element	The cost difference, not divided by the extra quitters.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A nutrition assistance clinic with long waits, ~~and a newly painted lobby mural~~, tries a new check-in process on Tuesdays for two weeks. Staff then compare the measured wait times with what they predicted. Which PDSA phase is this comparison?

Target word: PDSA phase **Decides:** Analyzing results against the prediction.

A	Correct	Study compares results with predictions.
B	Inverted operation	Act follows Study: deciding to adopt, adapt, or abandon.
C	Adjacent category	Plan designs the test and makes the prediction.
D	Confusion set	Do is running the test and collecting data.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A county immunization clinic ~~under a newly hired director~~ tracks the percentage of children who receive each vaccine on the recommended schedule. In Donabedian's model, what kind of measure is this?

Target word: measure type **Decides:** Whether care was delivered as it should be.

A	Adjacent category	Structure covers staff, equipment, and facilities.
B	Camouflage	Reacts to the director detail; the measure is about care delivery.
C	Correct	Measures what was done and whether it met the standard.
D	Confusion set	An outcome would be disease rates among children.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A clinic reports the number of certified vaccinators on staff and whether its vaccine refrigerators meet temperature standards. What kind of measures are these?

Target word: measure type **Decides:** Resources and settings.

A	Confusion set	Outcomes are health results.
B	Inverted operation	Impact is long-term population change, the far end of the chain.
C	Adjacent category	Process is how care is delivered.
D	Correct	Staff credentials and equipment are structure.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A person with active tuberculosis, ~~who runs a popular neighborhood bakery,~~ keeps missing doses of treatment. What should the health department try first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** Least restrictive effective option.

A	Camouflage	Reacts to the job detail; does not ensure treatment.
B	Adjacent category	Ignores the risk to others.
C	Inverted operation	Starts with the most restrictive option.
D	Correct	Effective and much less restrictive than detention.

8. Answer C Concept 6

Each month, an administrator at a public health clinic ~~that recently upgraded its phone system~~ compares actual patient visits with targets and adjusts staffing when visits fall short. Which management function is this?

Target word: management function **Decides:** Comparing results with standards and correcting.

A	Confusion set	Organizing designs structure and assigns resources.
B	Dropped element	Leading motivates people; it leaves out the comparison to targets.
C	Correct	Monitoring against targets and correcting is controlling.
D	Adjacent category	Planning sets the targets in the first place.

9. Answer B Concept 7

~~At a press event,~~ a state announces federal funds that may be used only for childhood lead-poisoning prevention activities listed by the funder. What type of grant is this?

Target word: grant type **Decides:** Narrowly restricted uses.

A	Inverted operation	Block grants give broad flexibility.
B	Correct	Funds restricted to a specific purpose.
C	Absolute language	Grant terms limit allowable uses.
D	Confusion set	General revenue has no purpose restriction.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A state wants federal funding that it can spread across several prevention priorities it selects itself. Which type of grant fits?

Target word: grant type **Decides:** Needs broad flexibility.

A	Confusion set	Not federal grant funding.
B	Inverted operation	Categorical grants restrict use to one purpose.
C	Correct	Block grants allow flexible use within a broad area.
D	Adjacent category	Even narrower than categorical.

11. Answer A Concept 8

In a SWOT analysis, a local health department, ~~whose director recently spoke at a national conference,~~ lists this item: A new state law will cut funding for local health departments next year. Where does it belong?

Target word: SWOT category **Decides:** External and negative.

A	Correct	An outside factor that could harm the department.
B	Inverted operation	External but negative, not positive.
C	Confusion set	Weaknesses are internal.
D	Adjacent category	Strengths are internal positives.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

In the same SWOT analysis, the department notes that many of its nurses are bilingual. Where does this belong?

Target word: SWOT category **Decides:** Internal and positive.

A	Confusion set	Threats are external negatives.
B	Correct	An internal asset.
C	Inverted operation	Internal, but positive.
D	Adjacent category	Opportunities are external.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	3	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Transformational vs. transactional leadership	Transformational leaders build a shared vision and develop people, which fits major change; transactional leaders manage through rewards and corrections for set tasks.	Relying on rewards and penalties alone during large-scale change.	A merger, reorganization, or morale crisis.
2	Cost-effectiveness	Compare programs by cost per unit of outcome; the incremental ratio = extra cost ÷ extra outcome of choosing one program over another.	Choosing by total cost or total effect alone.	Two programs with different costs and results.
3	The PDSA cycle	Plan a change and predict results; Do it on a small scale; Study the data against the prediction; Act by adopting, adapting, or abandoning.	Calling data analysis the Do step, or skipping the small-scale test.	A step in a quality improvement test to classify.
4	Structure, process, outcome	Structure = resources and settings; process = what is done and how well; outcome = the resulting health status.	Calling a protocol-adherence rate an outcome.	A quality measure to classify.
5	Least restrictive means	Public health ethics requires using the least restrictive intervention that can achieve the goal before escalating to coercion.	Jumping to detention, or doing nothing in the name of autonomy.	A person not following a needed public health measure.
6	Functions of management	Planning sets goals; organizing arranges resources and structure; leading motivates people; controlling compares performance with standards and corrects.	Calling monitoring against targets planning.	A manager reviewing results against goals.
7	Categorical vs. block grants	Categorical grants restrict funds to a narrow, specified purpose; block grants give recipients broad flexibility within a general area.	Reversing which type offers flexibility.	How narrowly the funder defines allowed uses.
8	SWOT analysis	Strengths and weaknesses are internal; opportunities and threats are external.	Classifying an outside funding cut as a weakness.	An item to place in a SWOT grid.

Course scope (public description): Public Health Administration is designed to provide students with a comprehensive understanding of the principles, practices, and challenges of managing healthcare organizations in today's complex healthcare environment. It explores the critical aspects of Public Health Administration, including leadership, healthcare policy, financial management, quality improvement, and ethical considerations.